

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

(Please print or type. Attach photographs, drawings, and additional pages if necessary.)

Red 1/6/00 upl

Species: Red-shouldered Hawk (Common Name) Buteo lineatus lineatus race (Scientific Name)

Date(s) of observation: 1/3/2000

Number of birds seen: 1 Sex: ? Plumage: immature

Exact location: west of Riverside Cemetery along So. Platte River

County: Adams Nearest town: Thornton Elevation: 5268'

Length of observation: 30 minutes Times(s) of observation: 1245 - 1315 Mt. stand. time

Other observers who saw the bird(s) with you: none

Other observers who independently saw the bird(s): Dick Schottler 1/1/2000

Light conditions (quality; direction relative to bird's; position): overcast

Optical equipment used: Swarovski 8x 56 Binoc., Kowa scope 20-60 zoom

Distance from bird(s) (estimated unless otherwise noted): 130 yds.

Was bird photographed?: no If so, have you submitted photographs? _____

Who took the photographs? _____

Describe the general and specific habitat in which the bird(s) occurred: Narrow, long stretch of woods adjacent to the South Platte River in industrial metro area. Perched mid-way up 60-70' cottonwoods. Large marsh and pond area to the east, then open cemetery with scattered trees.

Describe the bird's behavior (flying; feeding; habits; behaviors used in identifying the species or in supporting the identification):

Perched, actively looking about, alert; not intimidated by 2 BBMA flanking both sides of it.

Describe the bird(s) in detail. This is the most important part of this report. Include overall size and shape, and how you placed the bird(s) in the general group that you did. Give complete details of plumage, including head, throat, undersides, nape, back, wings, and tail. Give particular emphasis to marks you used to identify the bird. Describe other details, such as color and shape of bill, legs, eye, (etc.) that were important in making the identification. (Fill out this portion even if photographs are submitted; you may attach additional sheets, drawings, field sketches, or copy of field notes):

over

Describe bird's call or song:

none

Discuss similar species and how you eliminated them:

over

What is your prior experience with this and similarly appearing species? (a) * (i) Red-shouldered Hawks eastern races seen in Texas, Florida and Colorado, western races in Calif.; many RTHA across U.S.; (i) and (a) Broad-winged Hawks seen a dozen times in east Texas and Colorado.

List books, guides, recordings, or other sources consulted and how these influenced your identification (during and after observation):

Peterson "Hawks" and Nat. Geo guide used to compare my observations with texts and determine race.

This report was made from notes made during x or after _____ observation, or later from memory _____

Date of written report: 1/3/2000

Reporting observer: Karleen Schofield sure: Karleen Schofield

Observer's address: 33 Yates St., Denver, Colo. 80219 303 936 8661

Send report to: Bill Lisowsky, 2919 Silverplume Drive, Fort Collins, Colorado 80526

Red-shouldered Hawk 4/3/2000 cont.

General overall: Medium-sized hawk, dark brown uppers, underparts white/creamy white.

Head: dark with white streaking on head and nape extending onto face as finer streaks. Beak light gray with hooked black tip. Small circular white spot where forehead joins upper mandible/cere. Narrow chin and throat area dark brown, bordered on each side by white stripe which in turn is bordered by broad dark malar stripe, shading to medium brown on cheek. Thin white supercilium sets off mostly dark eye.

Uppers: White spotting on dark brown wing coverts gives brief impression of Red-tailed Hawk viewed from back, but spots scattered more extensively. Greater coverts buff centered on dark brown. Primaries dark brown, edged with buff, 5-7½ cm. shorter than tail. Long tail dark brown with multiple narrow light brown barring. In flight, white fringe on dark upper tail coverts.

Underparts: White from upper breast through under-tail coverts. Medium to heavy brown streaking from lower throat/upper breast to mid belly, some streaks broken into segments. Streaking more dense on upper breast. Leg feathering white. Legs not seen. In brief flight from tree to tree, underwings appeared pale. Wings spread on landing revealed narrow pale crescents near tips of wings contrasting against dark coverts and primaries.

(i) Broad-winged Hawk and (i) Red-tailed Hawk very similar. Broad-winged Hawk somewhat smaller size, shorter tail with wider bands, lacks pale crescent in outer wing; this species migrates to So. America for the winter.

(i) RTHA larger, lacks black/dark brown on throat and crescent-shaped area in outer wing. Breast generally streak-free, streaking mostly limited to belly region.

Karleen Schufeldt